KARIM ELSARHA

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Strategic Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager with 18+ years of experience managing full-spectrum procurement and Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) from office supplies to large-scale port infrastructure across major national projects within a Tier 1 Egyptian economic authority. Delivered a 35% reduction in procurement costs through structured negotiation and supplier consolidation and implemented AI-assisted demand forecasting and Power BI analytics that raised order fulfillment accuracy to 98% while reducing excess inventory by 55%. Deep expertise in FIDIC/USAID compliance, SAP MM, and supplier performance governance. Proven ability to lead cross-functional teams and align procurement strategy with organizational priorities across dynamic, high-value environments.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — *Cairo, Egypt*

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager | *Jan 2025 – Present*

- Maintains full compliance of procurement and inventory operations with FIDIC standards, legal frameworks, and governance requirements across all active contracts and purchasing cycles.
- Manages high-value contracts end-to-end, from bid evaluation through execution, with direct oversight of regulatory risk and contract disputes.
- Automated RFQ/RFP workflows in SAP MM, cutting bid cycle time by 60% and reducing manual processing errors by 80%.
- Leads supplier negotiations on payment terms and pricing, delivering a consistent 35% reduction in procurement costs without disrupting supply continuity.
- Works closely with legal and finance teams to clear contract approvals faster — delays dropped by 80% after restructuring the review process.
- Raised supplier on-time delivery from baseline to 65% above target by tying KPI scorecards directly to contract renewal decisions.
- Runs Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) across multiple sites using MIN-MAX levels, ABC classification, and demand forecasting — balancing stock availability against holding costs.
- Deployed real-time inventory tracking and AI-assisted forecasting through Power BI and Power Automate, reducing excess stock by 55% and lifting order fulfillment accuracy to 98%.
- Feeds inventory and demand data into S&OP discussions, keeping procurement aligned with project timelines and budget cycles.
- Manages and develops a team of 25, with a focus on accountability, technical upskilling, and clear performance standards.

Procurement & Inventory Control Section Head | *May 2016 – Jan 2025*

- Managed the full procurement cycle, including RFQ, ITB, and RFP processes, ensuring bid compliance and lifecycle governance.
- Evaluated and analyzed supplier quotes and proposals through in-depth assessments of pricing, delivery terms, technical specifications, and service quality.

- Built and onboarded a supplier base of 800+ vendors through a rigorous qualification system, resulting in the disqualification of 19% of underperforming suppliers and significant quality improvement.
- Conducted ongoing market research to identify sourcing opportunities, benchmark pricing, and align bid strategies with current market conditions.
- Oversaw day-to-day warehouse operations, ensuring efficient inventory control, accurate stock management, and smooth distribution workflows.
- Introduced barcode tracking for warehouse operations, significantly improving inventory accuracy and reducing stock discrepancies.

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA) — *Suez, Egypt*

Budgeting & Cost Accountant | *Jun 2008 – May 2016*

- Collected, analyzed, and reported on operational cost data to support management decision-making and cost control initiatives.
- Assessed the financial impact of changes in goods and services on overall operational costs.
- Prepared and contributed to the development of the organization's annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts.
- Monitored budget performance throughout the fiscal year, identifying variances and recommending corrective actions.
- Collaborated with department heads to gather budget inputs and ensure strategic alignment across the organization.

KEY SKILLS

Procurement & Contracting: Government Procurement, Strategic Sourcing, Supplier Negotiation, FIDIC/USAID Compliance, P2P (Procure-to-Pay), Category Management, Total Cost of Ownership (TCO).

Inventory & Supply Chain: Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP), Inventory Planning & Optimization, MIN-MAX Strategy, ABC Analysis, Demand Forecasting, Reorder Point Optimization, Lead-Time Modeling, AI-driven forecasting tools, S&OP Support.

Systems & Technology: SAP MM, Power BI, Advanced Excel, Barcode & Real-Time Tracking Systems, ERP Systems.

Leadership & Collaboration: Team Management (25+ professionals), Cross-functional Stakeholder Collaboration, Supplier Performance Management.

Languages: Arabic (Native) | English (Professional).

PROJECTS PORTFOLIO

General Procurement Projects

Managed end-to-end procurement for high-value categories including vehicles, IT equipment, office furniture, and critical spare parts, ensuring compliance, competitive pricing, and timely delivery.

Infrastructure Upgrade Projects

Led procurement and coordination for major infrastructure works, including the Sokhna Port control tower upgrade, Adabia Port development, and installation of a complete sewage station system.

Security & Safety Systems Projects

Oversaw sourcing and implementation of advanced safety systems, including fire suppression networks, explosive detection devices, and investor communication systems.

International Import Projects

Executed complex international procurement for critical port systems: navigational devices (Vissim – Norway), marine spare parts (Mapso – Switzerland), and a natural gas station unit (Pietro Fiorentini – Italy), ensuring full regulatory compliance and successful customs clearance.

Consultancy & Technical Studies Projects

Collaborated with global consultants on environmental studies for Ain Sokhna Port and supervised procurement for the Port Said Quays development program, ensuring alignment with environmental, technical, and operational frameworks.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Supply Chain Management — Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT), Egypt | In Progress

Bachelor's Degree in Commerce (Accounting) — Suez University, Egypt

Associate Degree in Management Information Systems — Suez Higher Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- PMP – Project Management Professional · *PMI · In Progress*
- Supply Chain Management · *LinkedIn Learning*
- Negotiation Skills · *LinkedIn Learning*
- Project Management Foundations: Procurement · *LinkedIn Learning*
- Inventory Management Foundations · *LinkedIn Learning*
- Problem-Solving & Troubleshooting · *LinkedIn Learning*

TRAINING & LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar

Academy for International Business Officials (AIBO) / China Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM), Beijing, China | Jul–Aug 2024. Participated as part of the official Egyptian delegation under China's Global Development Initiative at the New Industrialization Conference.

Behavioral Barriers in Leadership — National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt | 2022

Anti-Corruption Training — National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt | 2022

AVAILABILITY

Available to join within one month of offer acceptance.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.